

403 TOWN

Pilot Storyboard — “Color Missing” Updated with ZeroByte as the main villain

OPENING — THE 403 AREA BEFORE THE FALL

SHOT 1 — AERIAL VIEW

A wide overhead view of the entire 403 area.

Sultan, Startup, and Gold Bar sit along the same highway, surrounded by mountains, rivers, train tracks, bridges, and dense Washington forest.

Everything is vibrant, exaggerated, and alive.

The image resembles an old animated tourism postcard.

NARRATION:

“There used to be three little towns tucked between the mountains.”

SHOT 2 — SULTAN

The camera dives toward Sultan.

Buildings shimmer with digital patterns. Streetlights flicker through red, green, and blue. Signs briefly duplicate themselves before snapping back together.

The glitches are not damage yet. They are part of the town's personality.

Children chase RGB-colored pixels through the streets.

Local artists paint walls that animate when nobody is looking.

Music leaks from garages, basements, and open car windows.

NARRATION:

“Sultan was always a little unstable.”

“Not broken.”

“Just built differently.”

SHOT 3 — STARTUP

The camera races east toward Startup.

Wind tears through the narrow town.

Flags snap above storefronts. Leaves spiral between buildings. People move quickly, almost as though the town is permanently running late.

Doors open and slam shut on their own.

Bicycles, shopping carts, newspapers, and loose objects shoot through the streets.

Everything feels energetic and chaotic.

NARRATION:

“Startup never stopped moving.”

“Blink too long and the whole town might pass you by.”

SHOT 4 — GOLD BAR

The camera continues into Gold Bar.

Warm golden light reflects from rooftops, windows, machinery, and the river.

Huge capacitors, coils, power lines, and old electrical equipment are incorporated into the architecture.

Energy travels visibly through cables beneath transparent sections of pavement.

The entire town hums like a machine operating perfectly.

NARRATION:

“Gold Bar kept the current flowing.”

“Gold in the streets.”

“Power in the walls.”

THE SIGNAL

SHOT 5 — THE FOREST BETWEEN TOWNS

The music suddenly cuts out.

Deep inside the woods, television static appears between the trees.

It does not belong to any screen.

The static widens into a vertical tear in the world.

Behind it is nothing recognizable—only unfinished space, broken symbols, and fragments of raw code.

A figure steps through. It is ZeroByte, the corrupted form of Zero.

His body is dark and partially transparent. Static crawls across him. Streams of code move behind his face.

Only his eyes are visible.

They glow with scrolling green symbols.

NARRATION:

“Then something found us.”

SHOT 6 — THE UNKNOWN STATIC

ZeroByte reaches toward a living flower.

Thin black cords extend from his fingertips.

They pierce the flower without physically damaging it.

Its color travels through the cords and into his hand.

The flower turns grayscale.

Its petals become rigid and repeat the same movement over and over.

ZeroByte watches it carefully.

Not with anger.

With satisfaction.

ZEROBYTE:

“Unnecessary data removed.”

THE COLOR DRAIN

SHOT 7 — THE ATTACK SPREADS

A rapid montage begins.

Black cords travel beneath the roads like roots.

They enter Sultan through phone lines, traffic lights, electrical boxes, and abandoned computer equipment.

They catch in Startup’s wind and spread from building to building.

They attach themselves to Gold Bar’s capacitors and infect the town’s power system.

Color begins draining from all three towns.

Murals fade.

Signs lose their glow.

Trees turn gray.

Water becomes silver.

The sky becomes nearly white.

Music distorts and slows until it becomes a low mechanical drone.

SHOT 8 — PEOPLE BEING HIJACKED

A grayscale resident stands alone at a bus stop.

One of ZeroByte’s corrupted followers approaches.

The bad guy still has color, but his face is obscured by code. Digital symbols scroll where his eyes and mouth should be.

Cords emerge from his fingers and attach to the resident’s back, neck, and head.

The resident freezes.

Their eyes fill with code.

A small amount of unnatural color returns to their clothes—but it is harsh, corrupted, and controlled.

They turn toward the camera.

They are no longer an ordinary resident.

They have become part of ZeroByte's network.

SYSTEM VOICE:

“Local process overwritten.”

DATE STREET

SHOT 9 — PRESENT DAY SULTAN

The screen flickers.

The vibrant past is gone.

Present-day Sultan is almost entirely black and white.

The buildings are worn. Streets are cracked. Digital artifacts crawl across walls and street signs.

Occasional RGB fragments still appear around broken electronics, graffiti, and damaged parts of the town.

The glitches that once gave Sultan personality now look like open wounds.

Grayscale residents repeat familiar routines.

A cashier wipes the same section of counter.

A pedestrian crosses the same street, disappears, and begins again.

A mechanic repeatedly drops the same wrench.

They resemble people, but something essential has been removed.

SHOT 10 — DATE STREET

The camera moves toward Date Street.

Unlike the rest of Sultan, small traces of color remain here.

Graffiti shines beneath bridges.

Posters move when the wind is not blowing.

Colored cables run between garages, bedrooms, abandoned workshops, and warehouses.

This is where the good crew lives.

Their homes are imperfect, crowded, and built from salvaged pieces of the old world.

Date Street has not survived because it is protected.

It has survived because the people living there refuse to stop creating.

INTRODUCING THE CREW

SHOT 11 — KODE

Inside a cluttered garage, Kode repairs a device using mismatched wires, old game hardware, broken speakers, and pieces of discarded machinery.

His bat rests against the workbench.

A dead monitor suddenly displays a single colored pixel.

Kode notices it.

He taps the screen.

The pixel moves east across a crude map of the 403 area.

Toward the woods surrounding Startup.

SHOT 12 — atRISK

In the next room, atRisk stands in front of a microphone.

The room is grayscale except for him, the microphone, and waves of color created by his voice.

Each line he performs sends brief pulses through the building.

The pulses restore color to nearby objects for a few seconds.

A poster becomes vibrant.

A dying plant turns green.

An old photograph briefly comes back to life.

Then the color drains away again.

Kode enters and holds up the tracking device.

KODE:

“We got another signal.”

atRisk looks at the moving pixel.

atRISK:

“That ain’t a signal.”

He grabs the microphone.

atRISK:

“That’s somebody asking for help.”

THE FIRST MISSION

SHOT 13 — THE HIJACKING

Elsewhere in Sultan, a young grayscale resident runs through an alley.

Three corrupted enemies pursue them.

Their bodies retain distorted colors, but their faces flicker with symbols and code.

One enemy extends cords from both hands.

The cords snake around corners, climb walls, and grab the resident by the ankles.

The resident is pulled backward.

Additional cords connect to their head and shoulders.

Their body begins converting.

Kode and atRisk appear at the end of the alley.

Kode raises his bat.

atRisk grips the microphone.

The conversion stops halfway.

The resident's face flickers between their original eyes and green scrolling code.

SHOT 14 — FIRST CONFRONTATION

The enemies turn toward the crew.

Their faces synchronize.

ZeroByte speaks through all three of them at once.

ZEROBYTE:

“Color is corruption.”

“Creation produces instability.”

“Resistance will be simplified.”

atRisk looks around at the empty gray town.

atRISK:

“Yeah?”

He switches on the microphone.

A wave of color spreads across the alley.

atRISK:

“Then let's make this complicated.”

Music begins.

Kode charges.

The first full song or action sequence starts.

ENDING IMAGE

After the confrontation, the rescued resident retains one tiny patch of natural color.

The crew watches it carefully.

This is the first proof that stolen color can be restored.

Far away, inside the unknown static, ZeroByte observes them through hundreds of hijacked eyes.

A map of Sultan appears before him.

Date Street pulses in color.

He places one hand over it.

Black cords begin spreading toward the neighborhood.

ZEROBYTE:

“Source located.”

Cut to black.

VISUAL RULES

The environments are predominantly black, white, and gray.

Main characters retain their natural color palettes.

Enemy characters use aggressive or corrupted colors that visibly clash with the heroes.

Enemy faces and eyes contain digital code, static, error symbols, scan lines, or incomplete facial features.

Ordinary residents are grayscale until they are hijacked.

Hijacked residents regain artificial color, distinguishing them from both ordinary residents and ZeroByte's corrupted forces.

Sultan's glitches use red, green, and blue separation.

Startup's visual movement is driven by wind, speed lines, swinging signs, flying debris, and rapidly moving clouds.

Gold Bar uses warm gold lighting, electrical arcs, capacitors, coils, transformers, and visible energy currents.

ZeroByte's cords behave like a mixture of computer cables, puppet strings, veins, and invasive roots.

Music and acts of creation temporarily restore color.

Permanent restoration requires freeing the victim's original code rather than merely defeating the enemy controlling them.

NEXT STEP

The next step should be turning the final confrontation into the opening song, so the exposition naturally transitions into Kode and atRisk's first mission.